

Chapter 18

The next day, before Yin Lingzhu had even woken up, she received a phone call from Yang Daiyi saying there was an urgent matter to discuss with her.

Since Yang Daiyi didn't specify what the matter was over the phone, Yin Lingzhu could only rush to the studio as quickly as possible.

"Sister Yang, what's—" She pushed open the door, but her words came to an abrupt halt.

Yan Si was also inside.

Yang Daiyi sat next to Yan Si, but Yin Lingzhu could see that Yang Daiyi looked like she was sitting on needles, her whole body tense.

"Sister Yang, didn't you say you had something to attend to?" Yin Lingzhu closed the door and smiled at Yang Daiyi.

This was an excuse anyone could see through, but no one called it out.

Yang Daiyi heard Yin Lingzhu's words and jumped up from her chair, "Little Yin, if you hadn't mentioned it, I would have forgotten."

Yang Daiyi quickly walked to the door, and when she passed by Yin Lingzhu, she gave her a meaningful look.

Outside, Yang Daiyi tried to calm her racing heartbeat. Early this morning, Yan Si had arrived with not a trace of a smile on her face, completely different from her usual demeanor.

Yang Daiyi had initially been quite happy to see Yan Si arrive—after all, this was a movie queen¹, and getting even a bit of resources from her would be better than all her exhausting efforts at dinner tables.

However, seeing Yan Si's expression today, it was clear she hadn't come with good intentions.

She'd just have to see how Little Yin would handle this.

"I waited for you for a long time last night." Yan Si looked at Yin Lingzhu and spoke.

Her voice was steady, seemingly without any change, appearing indifferent.

But this was merely maintaining her surface pride.

"I was busy last night, sorry." Yin Lingzhu's voice was also flat, equally without fluctuation.

It was as if both of them didn't care about what had happened last night.

"I'll definitely go tonight." Yin Lingzhu added another sentence.

Yan Si heard her words, "Are you certain you'll definitely come tonight?"

"I don't want to waste my time waiting for someone who won't show up." Yan Si explained.

"I will." Yin Lingzhu said firmly.

She could feel her heart beginning to waver more and more.

She had to stay away from Yan Si, even if it would make her heart ache.

"Very well, I'll wait for you all night tonight." Yan Si was satisfied with Yin Lingzhu's answer. She nodded and got up to leave.

Yin Lingzhu watched Yan Si's back gradually grow smaller until it was blocked by the door.

Yang Daiyi had been secretly watching the studio from a hidden spot. Although she couldn't see the specific situation inside, she could see who came out.

Seeing Yan Si emerge from the studio, Yang Daiyi quickly slipped into the room.

"What happened between you and President Yan again?" Yang Daiyi asked nervously.

"Nothing much, she and I will soon have no relationship." Yin Lingzhu suppressed the reluctance and sadness in her heart, closed her eyes, and leaned back against the sofa.

She casually found a topic to try to numb herself through conversation, "Why did you use the word 'again'?"

Yang Daiyi also imitated her posture, leaning against the sofa back, "I've been at the company for three years, and in three years I hadn't seen President Yan once. These past few days, it's almost been a daily occurrence."

"And President Yan comes looking for you every time. As for what's between you and President Yan, I'm too lazy to ask."

"Even if I asked, you wouldn't tell me, and besides, President Yan's gossip isn't something someone like me should be asking about."

Yin Lingzhu glanced at her, "Really don't want to know?"

Yang Daiyi turned her head away, "Don't want to." *Like hell.*

Since Yan Si's debut, she'd had no scandals. So many paparazzi, yet they couldn't dig up even a bit of dirt.

Now she had a chance to know gossip that so many people didn't know—how could she not want to know?

But Yang Daiyi was also very clear that curiosity killed the cat².

Just based on the frequency with which Yan Si actively sought out Yin Lingzhu, she was certain that Yan Si definitely favored Yin Lingzhu.

"I've selected a variety show for you here."

Yang Daiyi finished this sentence and didn't hear Yin Lingzhu's voice for a long time.

She turned her head toward Yin Lingzhu's direction.

Seeing Yin Lingzhu's eyes tightly closed, she realized that while her mind had been wandering, Yin Lingzhu had fallen asleep.

Yang Daiyi didn't wake her either. She knew about last night's situation.

Last night, Yin Lingzhu had actually drunk the most.

She should let her sleep for a while.

In such an uncomfortable position, Yin Lingzhu managed to sleep until noon before waking up.

As soon as she woke up, she saw Wan Miaoyin sitting beside her.

"Why are you here?" Yin Lingzhu's voice was a bit hoarse, but it added a lazy quality to her demeanor.

Wan Miaoyin poured her a cup of warm water, "Sister Yang asked me to wait for you to wake up and then tell you that there's a variety show she's already signed us up for."

"Last night, thank you for helping me block those drinks." Wan Miaoyin's voice carried some shyness.

"No need to thank me. In that situation, I would have helped anyone, and likewise, anyone would have helped you." Yin Lingzhu said a long string of words.

"Regardless, I still want to thank you." Wan Miaoyin said after hearing Yin Lingzhu's last sentence.

"Come look at the content of this variety show." Wan Miaoyin searched on the big screen and played the first season of the variety show.

After watching the first episode, Yin Lingzhu had a general understanding.

This variety show was organized into teams, with each team requiring at least two people.

Each episode would feature team-versus-team competitions, until the final episode when one team would emerge victorious.

The competition format was stage PK³, which could be singing or dancing.

"We can handle singing, but dancing is our weak point." Wan Miaoyin analyzed.

On screen, the people on stage were performing with all their might, their movements showcasing vitality and effort.

"Right, that's exactly why we need to practice hard." Yin Lingzhu agreed with her assessment.

"Let's rest today and tomorrow, and gather here at eight in the morning the day after tomorrow." Yin Lingzhu said to Wan Miaoyin beside her, while also notifying Kong Murui on her phone.

Around seven in the evening, Yin Lingzhu went out. When she got in the taxi, she was still confidently calculating the time.

She'd arrive at Yan Si's apartment by seven-thirty—definitely wouldn't be late.

Later, Yin Lingzhu stared blankly out the window with a wooden expression. She could see that there was a traffic jam ahead.

Why did it have to be a traffic jam today, at this time?

"Master, how much longer?" Yin Lingzhu asked the driver.

"Don't worry, I'll move as soon as I can, okay?" The driver stuck his head out the window, clearly also very anxious.

Seeing his expression, Yin Lingzhu felt too embarrassed to rush him anymore.

Perhaps the traffic jam was meant to be.

She took out her phone and opened Yan Si's phone number.

After hesitating, she didn't dial. This matter should be resolved as soon as possible—the longer it dragged on, she had a feeling it would become very troublesome.

This road was jammed for over an hour. By the time Yin Lingzhu reached the bottom of Yan Si's apartment building, it was almost nine o'clock.

Like last night, Yan Si was waiting on the balcony, her gaze focused on every person entering the apartment building.

When she saw Yin Lingzhu arrive, Yan Si smoothed out the wrinkles in her dress.

She sat up straight in the living room, having waited for the person she'd been expecting tonight.

When Yin Lingzhu had left before, she'd been quite decisive, leaving the keys in the apartment. She raised her hand and knocked on the door.

The door was opened almost immediately, making one suspect that Yan Si had been standing guard inside.

But Yin Lingzhu could hear Yan Si's breathing—she had jogged over.

"Yan Si, I've also signed the divorce agreement. Let's go get the divorce certificate this Sunday." Yin Lingzhu got straight to the point.

This was also her purpose for coming here—something that should have been done long ago. She'd been too busy recently and only remembered yesterday.

Yan Si hadn't had time to break into a smile when she heard Yin Lingzhu's words and froze in place.

"I won't go." Yan Si said after a long while.

Yan Si's hand gripped her dress tightly, creating ugly wrinkles that spread outward from her hand.

"Why do you want to divorce me?" Yan Si asked in confusion.

"You clearly love me so much."

Hearing Yan Si's question, Yin Lingzhu actually felt a sense of impatience.

"Yan Si, I did love you very much. I loved you so much I could have died for you, but that was in the past." Yin Lingzhu said each word clearly, her tone very heavy.

"Just consider that the Yin Lingzhu who loved you already died for you on the operating table."

"I won't go." Yan Si repeated that sentence.

"Why?" It was Yin Lingzhu's turn to ask this question.

Yan Si didn't speak. She didn't know how to explain.

Yin Lingzhu wouldn't believe that she liked her, and she had no need to explain.

Yin Lingzhu didn't get an answer. She lowered her head and made eye contact with Yan Si's pupils.

The two were silently competing.

In the end, it was Yin Lingzhu who gave up first, looking away.

"Think about it slowly. Come find me when you've decided." Yin Lingzhu dropped this line and tried to leave.

But Yan Si grabbed her sleeve.

"Could you sleep here tonight?" Yan Si's voice was small.

Yin Lingzhu thought she'd misheard.

Sleep here?

"Yan Si, are you okay? Do you have a fever? Why are you talking nonsense?" In her surprise, Yin Lingzhu spoke without thinking.

She looked at Yan Si's face again—fair with a hint of red, not looking like someone who was sick.

"I'm fine." Yan Si noticed Yin Lingzhu's gaze falling on her cheek and lowered her head.

She wasn't wearing makeup today—she probably didn't look good.

Yin Lingzhu looked at the top of the head in front of her and the black hair, feeling somewhat incredulous.

"Yan Si, you don't need to cling to me." Yin Lingzhu coldly stepped back, pulling away from Yan Si.

"If you want a lapdog⁴ like me, there's no need. With your conditions, you could just shout on the street and plenty of people would be your lapdogs."

"They'd do better than me." Yin Lingzhu's voice carried mockery, stabbing at Yan Si's heart.

Yan Si's lips opened and closed, but she couldn't say a word.

After a long while, Yan Si seemed to find her ability to speak again.

"I don't think of you as my lapdog."

"You're the person I like."

Yin Lingzhu acted as if she'd heard the biggest joke, unable to help but speak, "Yan Si, I can't feel your liking, and I can't bear it either."

What kind of liking would take someone's life?

Yin Lingzhu suspected that if it weren't for her S-level constitution, she really would have died on that operating table.

"Stay tonight, and we'll go to the civil affairs bureau⁵ this week."

Yin Lingzhu's steps toward the exit stopped. "Really?"

"Really."

Footnotes:

¹ **Movie Queen (影后)**: A title given to the best actress award winner at major Chinese film festivals, equivalent to "Best Actress." It's a prestigious title in the Chinese entertainment industry.

² **Curiosity killed the cat**: This is a direct translation that works in both languages, referring to the danger of being too curious or nosy.

³ **PK**: Borrowed from English "Player Kill," commonly used in Chinese internet culture to mean "versus" or "competition/battle."

⁴ **Lapdog (舔狗)**: Internet slang literally meaning "licking dog," referring to someone who desperately seeks someone else's attention and affection, often in a submissive or degrading way.

⁵ **Civil Affairs Bureau**: The government office in China where marriages and divorces are officially registered and processed.